



» JAVELIN THROW

New kid on the block

At the German Winter Throwing Championships in Halle, 19-year-old Max Dehning **announced himself emphatically** with a mammoth season opener of 90.20m.

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About a week ago, unless you were a track and field nerd, chances are that the name, Max Dehning, wouldn't have rung many bells.

He was certainly considered a prospect, with a silver medal at the 2022 Junior Worlds. But at just 19 years of age and with a personal best of just 79.13m, the understanding was that Dehning was still a long way from being the real deal.

No one's ignoring him any longer, though.

On Sunday last week, at the German Winter Throwing Championships in Halle, the teenager announced himself emphatically with a mammoth season opener of 90.20m.

With that, Dehning launched himself into one of the most exclusive cliques in world athletics — the 90m club in the men's javelin throw. For perspective, more athletes have run the 100m faster than 9.85 seconds than have thrown the javelin over 90m.

Dehning also became the youngest ever to cross the 90m mark — beating three-time Olympic medallist Steve Backley who first crossed the milestone at 23. Incidentally, his throw was also a new junior world record —